

A CLAY MODEL

Edtech firm Hero Vired's Founder Akshay Munjal is passionate about creating sculptures out of clay

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CREATIVE QUEST Akshay Munjal loves sculpting with clay because of its temperamental nature

A **KSHAY MUNJAL** is an entrepreneur with a difference. The third-generation business tycoon who hails from the prominent Munjal family, the driving force behind the Hero Group, can, in many ways, be called the architect of the group's BML Munjal University.

Last year, he forayed into the burgeoning edtech space by launching his venture, Hero Vired. However, above and beyond the confines of corporate life, the very soft-spoken Munjal is an artist at heart—when not overseeing operations at Hero Vired, he loves to immerse himself into sculpting. The 42-year-old entrepreneur has a special fondness for clay.

“If you look at sculpture per se, it is one of the oldest art forms known to mankind. If you look at clay, it is devoid of form. But in the hands of an artist, it can be sculpted into

some of the most beautiful objects you can see. It is just you and the sculpture. There are no external environments, no intermediaries,” says Munjal.

According to him, working with clay is a different experience altogether over other materials like wood. “Clay is a very temperamental medium. It needs to be handled with care. If you put too much water into it, it will become soft and soggy. If you don’t put adequate water, it will harden and crack. So there is a beautiful sense of balance that is needed in handling clay,” he explains.

Munjal always had a soft corner for art and the crafts, going back to his early days in school. This was also the time when he first encountered clay. “I used to love painting, then I discovered oil painting. But you know, when I encountered clay for the first time, all my interest in other forms of art fell by the wayside.